



MONTHLY UPDATE

Morocco: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-28 • 47 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH • GOVERNANCE • FINANCE • ICT INFRASTRUCTURE • DPI • TECHNOLOGY • CAPACITY • INCLUSION • DATA • GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

Police patrol vehicles carrying live facial recognition entered field service in Rabat in the week of 20 July 2026, with Casablanca and Tangier announced next ([deployment account](#)). Neither held account cites a data-protection authorisation, a retention rule or an oversight mechanism for them.

The month's other movements were commitments rather than deliveries. A memorandum with a data-centre equipment supplier was signed on 27 July with no sum attached ([ministry communique](#)), a 50-article digital health bill was adopted in the government council on 22 July ([bill account](#)), and the ministry named entry into force of a US\$250m programme before 23 September as its immediate priority ([ministry account](#)).

The ombudsman's 2025 report, presented on 23 July, recorded 9,958 files opened and a mean 815 days to implement a recommendation ([report account](#)).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Digital Morocco 2030 is in force with a [US\\$250m acceleration programme attached in June](#), against a [technology sector at 6.8% of gross domestic product on a 2025 figure](#). Two held sources give its 2030 jobs target as 150,000 and as 240,000, and neither reconciles with the other.

Legislation and regulation

A 50-article digital health bill was adopted in the government council on 22 July 2026, creating a national health identifier and a shared medical record under a new digitisation agency, with implementing decrees due within 12 months of publication and provider connection within 24 months of the technical decree ([bill account](#)). [Unlawful consultation, use or exchange of personal health data would draw six months to a year and MAD 50,000-200,000](#).

A constitutional-law academic stated on 30 July that the revised electoral framework criminalises use of artificial intelligence to distort the truth or intrude on the private lives of candidates and voters, naming no law, article number or gazette reference ([commentary](#)).

The data-protection statute is being recast rather than replaced. The regulator's president stated on the record that a recast of law 09-08, developed with the justice ministry, has entered the legislative circuit and been sent to the secretariat general of the government; he describes it as clarification rather than replacement. The [law itself has been in force since 2009](#), and no transmission date or text for the recast is held.

Data protection

Live facial recognition entered service in Rabat in the same weeks ([deployment account](#)), presented by the police directorate as domestically engineered and reported with an up-to-95% plate-recognition figure ([second account](#)).

Regional collaboration

Morocco was elected to the African Telecommunications Union's Administrative Council for 2027-2031 at the union's plenipotentiary conference in Abuja on 25 July, with a delegation combining the digital ministry, the regulator and the development agency ([ministry communique](#)).

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Simplification is law and is not yet practice. A member's written question to the digital transition ministry put the ombudsman's 2025 finding on the record: [agencies still ask citizens for paper copies of documents the administration already holds electronically, and impose undisclosed extra conditions](#), which is what the procedural simplification law was passed to stop. No ministry answer is held. The complaint from the other end is about coverage rather than paperwork: residents of one Sefrou commune [are asking for new or strengthened transmission stations, describing reliable connectivity as a condition of schooling, work and emergency access](#).

Finance

New investments

The ministry stated on 22 July that the digital transformation acceleration programme, approved and signed in June 2026, is backed by US\$250m over five years, and that bringing it into force before 23 September 2026 was its immediate priority ([ministry account](#)). The programme was not in force at 6 August.

A corporate venture fund of US\$250m, writing cheques of up to US\$5m into regional start-ups, was reported operating on 2 August, the figure attributed by the reporting outlet to a third-party tracker rather than to any Moroccan disclosure ([tracker account](#)).

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

An operator and a vendor placed a dual-band radio configuration into commercial service along the high-speed rail and motorway corridors on 30 July 2026, claiming a 13 dB coverage gain, 83% higher average downlink throughput and 3.2 times the active users with no additional sites built ([deployment account](#)). Every performance figure is the operator's and the vendor's own.

The transitional reduction of mobile interconnection tariff asymmetry took effect on 1 July 2026, running to 31 January 2027, with full symmetry from 1 February 2027, recorded in the incumbent's own half-year filing ([operator filing](#)).

The vendor has since put figures on it: [roughly a kilometre of extra range, an 83% download-speed gain and 3.2 times more concurrent users per site](#), against a regulator count of 19.4m mobile subscriptions and a 34.04% share for the operator at the end of March. The performance gains are the vendor's own.

Data Storage

The ministry signed a memorandum of understanding with a data-centre power and cooling supplier in Rabat on 27 July, covering digital infrastructure, cloud, artificial intelligence, high-performance computing and data centres. The ministry's own text commits only to exchanged expertise, technical studies and the identification of structuring projects, and attaches no sum; the 50 MW sovereign data centre in Rabat is named as something the cooperation will feed ([ministry communique](#)). Parallel talks were held the same day with two other suppliers on the same ground.

The Dakhla campus acquired a shape without acquiring a date. It is [planned as a green data-centre campus under the Igoudar Numerique programme, one part for the kingdom's sovereign digital needs and another open to private investment, with feasibility studies launched in April 2026](#). No capacity, cost, operator or commissioning date is held for it, and the same account gives no national facility count that would place it in an estate.

The compute platform behind that estate acquired a price. A press account citing third-party analysis [puts the Casablanca project at roughly US\\$1.2bn and up to 500MW, naming a South Korean cloud operator, a chip maker and the platform's developer, with a second renewable-powered project planned for Dakhla](#). Neither figure comes from a filing, and the question the same account raises is whether hosting foreign-operated infrastructure builds anything domestic beyond the hosting.

Cybersecurity

The [national cybersecurity strategy to 2030 is now held in full: four pillars — governance, cyberspace resilience, capacity development and regional cooperation — with 11 objectives, 26 initiatives and 60 actions](#), succeeding the first strategy of 2012. Its workforce commitments carry no numbers, and [a separate held source dates a national cybersecurity strategy to 2023 with US\\$100m earmarked and an agency created](#) — whether the two are the same instrument is not established.

The state answered the claim before the month ended. The national security and territorial surveillance directorates [categorically denied on 27 August any intrusion into their information systems or security databases, placing the published records instead in databases run by insurance companies and social and health cover bodies, and warning against doctored photographs and falsified documents circulating as security material](#). No insurer or cover body has answered, no regulator has ruled, and the provenance is therefore contested rather than established.

Against that architecture the month produced a claimed breach of the security services themselves. A hacker group said on 24 August that it had [published the personal data of 70,000 police and intelligence agents, a leak former members of the intelligence services judge at least partly authentic and which discloses details not previously public, including the date of birth of the head of the police and internal intelligence](#). Whether it is a new breach is contested: a Moroccan outlet calls it an assemblage of data already compromised in earlier hacks, and Moroccan media have covered it only marginally. The same group claimed the 2025 breach of the social security fund. No official confirmation, notification or investigation is on record, which is the part that bears on the strategy above rather than the claim itself.

DPI

Data Exchange

A national water digital twin was described publicly on 28 July, to rest on a sovereign national data platform hosted in Morocco and fuse sensor networks, satellite observation and data from the basin agencies, the planning commission and engineering consultancies. The project lead put a first pilot 18 to 24 months away and gave no cost, budget line or procurement route ([project account](#)).

A platform already carrying national data went under inspection instead. The health ministry [put its national health-data platform through a security and performance audit running from July to September, covering infrastructure, application, database and cybersecurity on a 170,000 dirham budget](#), with no cyberattack or breach cited as the trigger. No findings are published.

Morocco [promulgated the OECD multilateral competent authority agreement on the exchange of country-by-country reports by dahir 1.26.72 of 28 July 2026](#), ending seven years of parliamentary blockage since signature. The first exchange partners and the start date are not on file.

Digital Identity and CRVS

The government council approved a draft decree on 9 July 2026 amending the 2008 biometric passport decree: four languages including Amazigh, an encrypted chip to international civil aviation standard, the holder's address removed from the biodata page and temporary passports abolished ([approval account](#)). Issuance is expected from August 2026, and the joint body that will set issuance procedures is not yet in place.

Registries

The month's registry work is a membership audit rather than a build. The interior ministry [launched a wide screening and update of the membership rolls of collective land communities, with circulars sent to community delegates through local authority officials from 22 August 2026, beginning in two regions and open to extension nationwide](#). Each listed member is to be verified for actual affiliation, legal majority and residence under law 62.17 and its implementing decree, on a single methodology so that criteria stop varying from one community to another.

Sectoral management information systems

The same 50-article digital health bill adopted in the government council on 22 July 2026 creates a shared medical record and a national health identifier under a new digitisation agency ([bill account](#)).

Other GovTech and e-Gov

An interior ministry circular reported on 25 July abolished 22 administrative certificates and replaced them with sworn declarations, on the ministry's finding that citizens had routinely been made to produce them with no legal basis, and confirmed that only procedures published on the national portal are legally enforceable ([circular account](#)).

Switzerland's economic secretariat, the World Bank Group and a Swiss innovation body launched a public-audit innovation challenge in Rabat on 22 July with the general finance inspectorate and the court of audit as institutional users; no budget, award size or timetable was announced ([launch account](#)).

The ombudsman's 2025 annual report, presented on 23 July, gives the counterpoint: 9,958 files opened, up more than 25% year on year, 1,653 settlement decisions, and a mean 815 days to implement a recommendation and 774 days to close a file ending in one ([report account](#)). The institution holds that several administrations moved existing steps onto platforms without reworking the underlying process, and attributes repeated demands for the same documents to weak interconnection of administrative databases ([commentary](#)).

One portal went the other way. The Court of Cassation's site [has been down for more than a week with no official explanation](#), on a bar-association lawyer's account, at a point where the courts increasingly expect rulings to be tracked online. No court or ministry statement is held.

Technology

AI

The one artificial-intelligence figure to move in the window is a ranking rather than a capability. Morocco is placed [87th globally and eighth in the MENA region on an index of government readiness for artificial intelligence, up fourteen places in 2025](#), which the account attributes to the AI Made in Morocco roadmap and a regional data-for-sustainable-development hub developed with UNDP. The index itself is not named in the record held, so the starting position is derived from the reported change rather than published directly – and neither the roadmap's own founding text nor any progress report against Digital Morocco 2030 is held.

The institutional side did move. Four public-interest institutes [were established by publication in the Official Gazette, covering artificial-intelligence research and sovereign systems, education, industrial automation and smart cities](#), under the national digital and artificial-intelligence strategies. No budget, staffing or opening date is stated for any of them.

ICT Industry

The industry and trade ministry [added video games to the innovation funding programme](#), so companies in the sector can now apply for government funding to develop and test new games. No allocation, ceiling or first award has been published.

Capacity

Training and skills

The ministry signed a memorandum with a consultancy in Rabat on 17 July 2026 covering artificial-intelligence skills-building across administrations, universities and research centres, support to institute-backed start-ups and public-service use cases, with no value, term, headcount target or delivery milestone disclosed ([memorandum account](#)).

Inclusion

Access to services

An operator's sustainability report published on 10 July recorded 6,000 internet boxes refurbished in Morocco during 2025, which the operator put at about EUR 1.5m in savings, within a regional programme that refurbished 164,000 boxes in 2025, up 43% on 2024 ([operator report](#)). The figures are the operator's own and unaudited in the held source.

Data

Open data

The open-data portal is operating with four published procedure volumes — [manuals for open-data officers and data managers](#), a [data-inventory methodology](#) and a [standards and formats manual](#) — and published datasets including a [1,028-entry start-up database](#). A steering committee of ten bodies was established in December 2019 and a readiness assessment carried out in 2020, whose report remains unheld. The portal's own dataset count, publication statistics and action plan are not held either.

Geopolitics

EU activities

Morocco holds [no European Union adequacy decision: the Commission's list names sixteen jurisdictions plus one international organisation, none of them in Africa](#). Neither source establishing this is tagged to Morocco, and no Morocco-tagged governance source the base holds mentions the European Union at all.

India activities

The direction became a structure. The two governments' digital ministers met in Rabat on 24 August and [agreed to establish a joint commission, its first focus language technologies for citizen dealings with government administrations, carrying multiple languages, variants and dialects, alongside collaboration around the JAZARI artificial-intelligence institutes](#); it builds on a New Delhi meeting in February on the margins of the AI Impact Summit, and no membership, budget or timetable accompanies it. The country is [turning to India to develop artificial intelligence adapted to its national languages](#). What is held is a stated direction and nothing more: no instrument, no partner institution, no language list, no budget and no timetable appear in the account. The row is minted because it opens a bilateral relationship this ledger did not previously record, not because anything has yet been agreed.

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